"Fiction can make people think about issues, can spark imaginations, can take people out of their own frame of reference"



YASIR IQBAL

"In trying to meet the challenges looming in our future, we will have to come closer, find greater meaning and allyship than before"

SANJEEV VERMA/GETTY IMAGES



KANISHK THAROOR, 37

Author, New York

Written in the Stars

For Kanishk, New York City has been home since he moved there at the age of six with his brother Ishan and parents. His father, Shashi Tharoor, was, of course, an influence, but it was in books that his mother, Tilottama Mukherji, read out—the *Old Testament*, *Shahnameh*, *The Persian Book of Kings*—that Kanishk found wonder. The older a text, the more historical its antecedence, the more was Kanishk drawn to it. His abiding love for folklore, for fable-like narratives that only the past makes possible, was made apparent by his first collection of short stories *Swimmer Among the Stars* (2016). "Fiction can make people think about issues, can spark imaginations, and can open doors," says Kanishk. He is presently working on a novel set in the 15th century. ■

–Shreevatsa Nevatia

REMAINS OF THE DAY When he is not writing, Kanishk presents a radio show, *Museum of Lost Objects*, on BBC 4. The series traces the histories of antiquities and landmarks destroyed in Iraq, Syria, India and Pakistan.